



SINGLE-VEHICLE RESEARCH DOSSIER

2004 Jeep Wrangler Rubicon

VIN 1J4FA69S54P720187

VIN	1J4FA69S54P720187 - check digit PASS
DECODES TO	2004 Wrangler TJ, Rubicon, 4.0L inline six, built in Toledo, Ohio
POSSIBLE LISTING	Euro Auto Sport, Chantilly, Virginia (unconfirmed - Section 5)
CONTEXT	Teen driver in Colorado; budget \$7,000-\$12,000; reliable years only
REPORT DATE	October 05, 2026

The short answer

This is a **genuine VIN for a 2004 TJ Rubicon with the 4.0 inline six** - a best-rated TJ year and the most capable Wrangler of its generation. No accident, salvage, auction or prior sale record for it surfaced anywhere in the open web. Whether it is the car at Euro Auto Sport is **not yet proven**: their indexed listing (stock #12280) shows no VIN and is titled "Sport" in one place, and \$9,999 is far below what a real Rubicon usually fetches. Get the VIN on stock #12280 confirmed before anything else.

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1. Findings at a glance

Status	Finding
VERIFIED	The VIN is genuine (ISO 3779 check digit passes).
VERIFIED	Model year 2004, 4.0L inline six, Toledo-built TJ.
STRONG	Trim is Rubicon: series code 6 is Rubicon in TJ decoder tables, and eight other authenticated 2004 VINs with the same 1J4FA69S pattern are all listed as Rubicons.
VERIFIED	Passes the reliable-year rules: 2004 is a best TJ year, after the 0331 head and before the OPDA failures.
NOT FOUND	No listing, auction, salvage, insurance-loss or prior-sale record for this VIN in any search index this environment could reach.
UNPROVEN	That it is the car for sale at Euro Auto Sport, Chantilly.
CONFLICT	Euro Auto Sport's 2004 (stock #12280) is titled "Sport" on one listing page and priced like a Sport.
RULED OUT	The burgundy 2004 Rubicon also in Chantilly is a different car (VIN ...784636, NOVA Autoland).
FILTER	As a Virginia-listed TJ, the automatic filter excludes it for frame-rot risk - see Section 7 for why a frame inspection, not the rule, should decide.

2. VIN decode, position by position

Pos	Value	Meaning	Grade
1-3	1J4	Jeep multipurpose vehicle, built in the USA (Chrysler-era WMI)	VERIFIED
4	F	GVWR / restraint class	PARTIAL
5	A	Vehicle line - Wrangler TJ, 4x4	PARTIAL
6	6	Series: Rubicon. TJ decoder tables list 6 = Rubicon from 2003, when the trim launched. Every other 1J4FA69S 2004 VIN found is a Rubicon.	STRONG
7	9	Body style - 2-door open body	PARTIAL
8	S	Engine: 4.0L inline six , unleaded (S = 4.0L in TJ decoder tables)	VERIFIED
9	5	Check digit - computed value is 5, VIN carries 5: PASS	VERIFIED
10	4	Model year 2004	VERIFIED
11	P	Assembly plant - Toledo, Ohio (code P; "Toledo #2" in TJ-era guides)	VERIFIED
12-17	720187	Production serial. The authenticated 2004 Rubicons found span 705056 to 784636; this one sits early in that run.	VERIFIED

Positions 4, 5 and 7 are graded PARTIAL because their exact code tables were not confirmed; none of them affects any conclusion here. The federal decoder at vpic.nhtsa.dot.gov returns the manufacturer's own record and should confirm trim and engine - it was unreachable from this environment.

2.1 Corroborating VINs

Eight other 2004 VINs with the same 1J4FA69S prefix surfaced in listings and auction indexes, every one described as a Rubicon. All eight pass the check digit:

1J4FA69SX4P710688	1J4FA69S34P705056	1J4FA69S64P728749	1J4FA69S44P736736
1J4FA69S64P755434	1J4FA69S34P755746	1J4FA69S64P756910	1J4FA69S94P784636

3. What a 2004 Rubicon is

The Rubicon was the off-road flagship of the TJ line from 2003. Factory equipment that separates it from a Sport or X - and that you should physically confirm, since a "Rubicon" with missing Rubicon hardware has either been parted out or is not one:

Component	Rubicon specification
Axles	Dana 44 front and rear (a Sport has a lighter Dana 30 front)
Lockers	Tru-Lok selectable air-actuated lockers front and rear; engage in 4-Low below about 10 mph
Transfer case	NV241 "Rock-Trac" with a 4:1 low range
Gearing	4.10 axle ratio
Driveshafts	Heavy-duty, 1330 u-joints
Engine	4.0L inline six, 190 hp
Transmission	Manual or automatic (Euro Auto Sport's car is listed as a 4-speed automatic)
Wheels and tyres	16x8 five-spoke aluminium, Goodyear Wrangler MT/R LT245/75R16
Body	Diamond-plate rocker guards; Rubicon badging
Brakes	Four-wheel discs

For a school-and-ski car, almost none of this matters day to day - lockers and a 4:1 crawl ratio are rock-crawling equipment. What matters is that the Rubicon is still a TJ with the durable 4.0, and that its hardware is a target for hard off-road use, which is why Section 9 asks for an abuse inspection.

4. History search: what was and was not found

The VIN was searched exactly, and against listing marketplaces, enthusiast auctions (Bring a Trailer, Cars & Bids, Hagerty), salvage and insurance auctions (Copart, IAAI and their archive sites) and free VIN-check aggregators.

Source class	Result for this VIN
Exact-VIN web search	One hit: a bulk index page of 2004 Wrangler VINs on a free mileage-check site. No vehicle-specific data.
Dealer and marketplace listings	None indexed under this VIN
Enthusiast auctions	None
Salvage / insurance auctions	None - while several sibling 2004 Rubicons do appear (one sold on Copart in May 2026 with a Tennessee salvage certificate)
Recalls (model-level)	Three on the 2004 Wrangler: a corrected tyre-information label, and two covering <i>aftermarket</i> Airtex fuel pumps and replacement brake master cylinders. None is a factory safety defect.

What "nothing found" means

Absence from public indexes is mildly reassuring - many total-loss vehicles leave a Copart or IAAI footprint that these sites archive - but it is **not** a clean history. Ownership count, accident reports, odometer readings, title brands and where the car has lived are only in CARFAX, AutoCheck and NMVTIS, all paid and all unreachable here. Those three checks are the next step, and the "where has it lived" answer decides the frame question in Section 7.

5. The Chantilly lead

Two 2004 Wranglers surfaced in Chantilly, Virginia:

	Euro Auto Sport	NOVA Autoland
Stock / VIN	Stock #12280; VIN not indexed	VIN 1J4FA69S94P784636
Trim as listed	"2004 Jeep Wrangler" - one listing page titles it Sport	Rubicon
Price	\$9,999	\$12,995 - \$13,995 (two indexed figures)
Mileage	91,290	47,779 - 47,795
Colour	Black	Burgundy, dark slate grey interior
Drivetrain	4.0L I6, 4-speed automatic, 4WD	4.0L I6
Is it this VIN?	Unknown	No - different serial

5.1 Reading the evidence

- If stock #12280 is a **Sport**, its VIN begins 1J4FA49S and it is not this car. The "Sport" title and the \$9,999 price, which matches 2004 Sport money, both point this way.
- If stock #12280 **is** this VIN, it is a Rubicon advertised as a Sport. That happens - dealers mislabel trims - and it would make \$9,999 a genuine bargain against Rubicon market prices. It would also mean you must physically confirm the Rubicon hardware in Section 3 is still on it.
- Listing data in this whole project has proved unreliable (several adverts carried the wrong year), so neither reading should be acted on until the dealer states the VIN.

One question settles it

Ask Euro Auto Sport: "What is the full VIN on stock #12280?" If it is 1J4FA69S54P720187, this dossier applies in full. If it is not, run whatever VIN they give you through wrangler_filter.py.

6. The dealer

	Euro Auto Sport (Euro Auto Sport LLC)
Address	25284 Pleasant Valley Rd, Unit 132, Chantilly, VA 20152
Phone	Indexed as both (571) 570-9050 and (571) 367-4620 - confirm which is current
Website	euroautosportllc.com
Type	Independent used-car dealer
Inventory profile	About 33 vehicles, median price about \$8,999, median 57 days listed
Reviews	A CARFAX dealer-review page exists; its rating could not be retrieved. No BBB profile surfaced under this name.

There is nothing negative on record, but there is also very little on record at all. For an independent lot with a thin public footprint, verify before you rely:

- **Licence.** Virginia dealers are licensed by the Motor Vehicle Dealer Board (mvdb.virginia.gov, 804-367-1100, dboard@mvdb.virginia.gov). Confirm Euro Auto Sport LLC holds a current licence.
- **Why it matters.** The Board's Motor Vehicle Transaction Recovery Fund can reimburse buyers who obtain a court judgment for fraud by a *licensed* dealer. That protection does not exist with an unlicensed seller.
- **Reviews.** Read the CARFAX dealer page and Google reviews yourself; look for specific complaints about title delays or undisclosed damage.

7. Risk assessment for this buyer

Risk	Assessment	
Virginia frame exposure	Northern Virginia salts its roads, and TJ frames rot from the inside out. Run as listed, the automatic filter returns EXCLUDED (TJ from a heavy road-salt state (VA) - frame-rot risk). That rule uses listing location as a proxy for history; for one specific car, the CARFAX location history and a hands-on frame inspection should decide. A long Virginia life plus visible frame scaling is a walk-away.	HIGH
No stability control	No TJ has electronic stability control - the main safety reason the earlier report preferred a 2014-2017 JK for a new driver.	HIGH
Mud-terrain tyres	If it still wears Rubicon-style MT/R tyres, they are poor on wet and icy pavement. Budget for mountain-snowflake winter tyres; Colorado's traction law requires rated tyres anyway.	MED
Off-road abuse	Rubicons get used for what they were built for. Check skid plates, differential covers and rocker guards for heavy scarring; check alignment for bent steering or axle parts; and test both air lockers - leaks and failed compressors are common age faults.	MED
Age	A 22-year-old vehicle: rubber, bushings, wiring and seals have aged regardless of mileage. 91,290 miles, if that is this car, is moderate for the age.	MED
Distance	Chantilly is roughly 1,650 miles from 80127. Shipping will cost more than the \$700-\$1,100 quoted earlier for 1,000-mile routes, and Colorado registration needs a DR 2698 VIN verification and an emissions test.	NOTE
Engine-specific faults	Not applicable: 2004 avoids the 2000-01 "0331" head and the 2005-06 OPDA failures. Normal 4.0 oil leaks still apply.	CLEAR

8. Value

Source	2004 Rubicon value
KBB private party	\$8,375 - \$10,850
Hagerty, good condition (July 2026)	\$16,667 - \$22,233
Chantilly, NOVA Autoland (47,779 mi)	\$12,995 - \$13,995 asking
Hillsborough CA (43,000 mi)	\$22,000 asking
Motor Car Classics (65,388 mi)	\$28,900 asking
eBay, 9,926 mi	Bid to \$37,500

KBB values the Rubicon like any 22-year-old SUV; the enthusiast market (Hagerty, real asking prices) treats it as a collectible. Real transactions sit between the two and rise steeply as mileage falls. For a 91,000-mile example in honest condition, **\$12,000-\$18,000** is a realistic market range. A \$9,999 Rubicon at that mileage would be either a mislabelled bargain or a car with a reason to be cheap - the same logic the filter applies to under-priced JKs. Either way it sits inside your \$12,000 budget, which almost no honest Rubicon does.

9. Questions for the dealer and inspection points

ASK BEFORE TRAVELLING
☐ Full VIN on stock #12280 - does it match 1J4FA69S54P720187?
☐ Is it a Rubicon or a Sport? Photos of the dash locker switch and Rubicon badging
☐ Clean title in the dealership's name? Any brand: salvage, rebuilt, flood?
☐ CARFAX or AutoCheck report - and where has the vehicle been registered over its life?
☐ Undercarriage and frame photos: rails, central skid plate area, rear control-arm mounts, body mounts
☐ Will they allow an independent pre-purchase inspection at a shop you choose?
☐ Out-the-door price including processing fees (Virginia dealers charge them)
RUBICON-SPECIFIC INSPECTION
☐ Dana 44 front axle present (not a swapped Dana 30)
☐ Both air lockers engage in 4-Low; compressor cycles off - a constantly running compressor means an air leak
☐ Rock-Trac 4:1 low range engages cleanly; no grinding
☐ Alignment readings - bent steering or axle parts show as abnormal camber
☐ Skid plates, differential covers, rocker guards: scarring level
☐ Lift or modification quality, if modified

TJ ESSENTIALS

- [] Frame tap test under the central skid plate and at the rear control-arm mounts
- [] Floor pans under the carpet; rear bumper and body mounts
- [] 4.0 oil leaks: rear main, timing cover, oil pan, valve cover
- [] Three VIN plates match: dash, door jamb, frame stamping
- [] NMVTIS title check plus your own history report before money moves

10. Sources

VIN decoding

- [quadratec.com](#) / [extremeterrain.com](#) / [wranglertjforum.com](#) / [getahelmet.com](#) - TJ VIN position tables (series 6 = Rubicon, S = 4.0L, P = Toledo)
- ISO 3779 / 49 CFR 565 - check digit, computed offline

Vehicle and siblings

- [windowwinreport.com](#) - bulk 2004 Wrangler VIN index
- [auction123.com](#) / [vms.autorevo.com](#) / [cars.com](#) / [carsandbids.com](#) / [motorcarclassics.com](#) - sibling 2004 Rubicon listings
- [vincheck.it.com](#) - sibling Copart records

Specification and faults

- [vms.autorevo.com](#) (Collins Bros Jeep) - 2004 Rubicon equipment
- [wranglertjforum.com](#) - buying a used TJ; Rubicon lockers
- [carcomplaints.com](#) / [autosafety.org](#) - 2004 Wrangler recalls

Value

- [hagerty.com](#) - 2004 Wrangler Rubicon value
- [kbb.com](#) - 2004 Rubicon
- [classic.com](#) / [ebay.com](#) - TJ market

Dealer

- [carsforsale.com](#) / [carzing.com](#) / [caredge.com](#) / [cruz.com](#) / [euroautosportllc.com](#) - Euro Auto Sport
- [carfax.com](#) - dealer review page
- [mvdb.virginia.gov](#) - dealer licensing, Transaction Recovery Fund

Research support only - not a vehicle history report, title search or inspection. Listing data is REPORTED and time-sensitive.